
Build, architecture and validation report

A council of role-agents on the subscription you already pay for.

ROLES	CEO · COO · CTO · Design
BACKENDS	Claude subscription · Codex subscription · API (opt-in)
RELEASE	v0.1.0-rc.1 · Go 1.27 · one binary
TESTS	76 test functions · all passing
METERED CALLS	0, across every real run
DATE	28 September 2026

PHASE 1 · SKELETON	DONE
PHASE 2 · PERSONAS	DONE
PHASE 3 · MASTER BUILD	DONE
FOLLOW-UP + HARNESS	DONE



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01 Executive summary

What Water is, the motto, and what exists today

Water is a single Go binary that hosts four role-agents: a singleton CEO, a COO, a CTO and Design. Each has its own persona, its own curated memory, and its own skills. They work on a problem through a typed, auditable message graph, and every model call runs through the `claude` or `codex` command-line tools you already pay for by subscription.

16,815

lines of Go, 2,850 of them tests

76

test functions across 23 packages

22

skills from verified research frameworks

0

metered calls in every real run

THE SINGLE MOST IMPORTANT EMPIRICAL FINDING

On briefs that arrive as a paragraph of assertions with nothing to check, the full graph reached the same headline decision as the CEO alone, at 8 to 11 times the calls. The graph earns its cost when there is something to gather.

What exists today

Capability	What it does
<code>water</code>	Opens the agent picker, then an interactive chat with one role. Slash commands, resumable transcripts, per-role themes, voice.
<code>water orchestrate</code>	Runs a brief through CEO → COO → CTO and Design → COO → CEO. Dissent reaches the CEO word for word.
Tool layer	Deny by default. Water serves file reads itself over MCP and records every call with its permission decision.
Identity binding	Every persona file carries its role id and a content hash; a mismatch fails loudly at startup.

07 Memory architecture

Five kinds of state and the isolation between them

"Memory" in Water is five different kinds of state with different owners, lifetimes and write rules. Keeping them apart is what keeps roles individual.

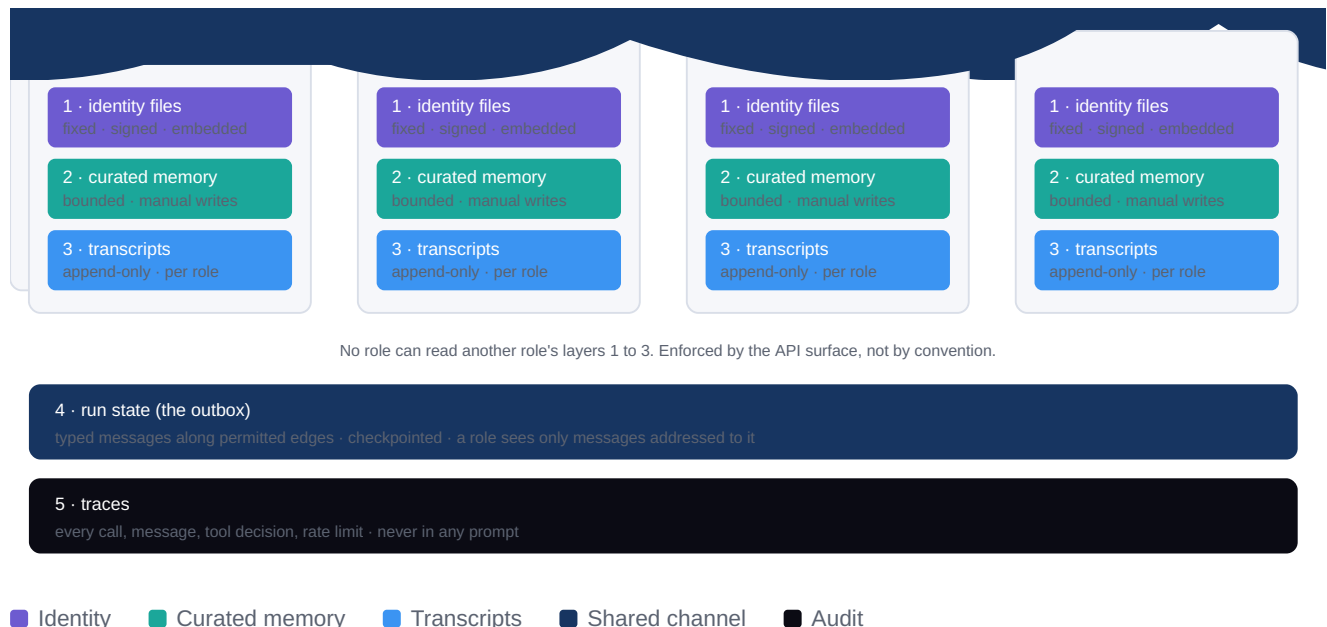


Figure 2. Five kinds of state. Layers 1 to 3 are private to a role; layer 4 is the only shared channel; layer 5 is for audit.

The isolation is structural

The memory interface a role receives is a scoped handle with no method that takes a role argument. A guard test reflects over that interface and fails if anyone adds one. A second guard runs a whole orchestration with a unique secret planted in each role's memory and asserts every prompt contains its own secret and no one else's.

WATCH

The most likely place to break isolation for convenience is letting one role look up what another knows. `/consult` returns an answer as a message, never a memory read.

IN PRACTICE

A 4 MB transcript opens from its tail and compacts. Compaction that requires loading the whole file is a documented failure elsewhere; Water reads the last 512 KB only.